GREEN COAST 2004 NZ ROGAINING CHAMPIONSHIPS – MARCH 6/7 2004

In March 2004, the **Green Coast 2004 NZ Rogaining Championships** will be held at Wairamarama, near Port Waikato, Auckland South. There will be approximately 70 checkpoints spread across 160 square kilometres. Teams will have 24 hours (with separate 16-hour and 6-hour options also available) to navigate on foot to as many checkpoints as possible. Registration for the event is now open.

The **Green Coast 2004 NZ Rogaining Championships** are endorsed by both the New Zealand Orienteering Federation and the New Zealand Rogaine Association as a national championships event.

Getting There: If travelling by air, competitors can either fly to Auckland or Hamilton airports. The event site is approximately 1 hours drive from Auckland, and 1¼ hours from Hamilton. The Hash House (event start/finish) can be reached by passenger car or campervan. Road directions are as follows:

> *From Auckland*: Travel south on the southern motorway over the Bombay Hills to the Pokeno exit. Turn off the motorway into Pokeno. From Pokeno, take first right into Whangarata Road and proceed about 10km to where the road ends at a T-junction (i.e. bypass the turn-off to Tuakau). At the T-junction, turn left and travel 4km to the Tuakau Bridge across the Waikato River (known as the Caterpillar Bridge). Cross the Bridge and after 100m turn right up the hill onto the Onewhero-Tuakau Road (do not turn hard right after the Caterpillar Bridge). Follow the signs from this junction to the event centre.
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> *From Hamilton*: Follow State Highway 1 north to Pokeno turn-off. Travel through Pokeno village centre and turn left into Whangarata Road at northern end. Then follow route above. (Note: It is possible to travel to the event centre from the south by other back-road (metalled) routes but this is slow and not recommended).

Accommodation and Camping: A large variety of hotels/motels are available in Auckland and Hamilton. The closest motel and campground accommodation is in Tuakau. Free camping is available (and encouraged) at the event centre at Wairamarama on Friday, Saturday and Sunday nights, however drinking and cooking water is available only – i.e. no showers etc. (although a swimming pool swim may be available).

Terrain: The event area consists of rolling limestone farmland country encompassing large pockets of pine trees and native bush, coastal scenery, limestone tomos and caves, spectacular waterfalls and stony bottom streams.

> No dogs will be allowed on the course or at the Hash-House.
> Weather permitting a full moon will be visible during the night hours of the event.
> The map scale will be 1:50,000.
> The area has not been embargoed for practical reasons. If you will be entering this area for any reason prior to 6 March 2004 we ask that you contact the event controller (Mark Copeland – (09) 578 2519) to tell him where you will be. Our goal is to run the fairest event possible.

Rogaine Rules: The **Green Coast 2004 NZ Rogaining Championships** will be run in accordance with a set of event rules (similar to the *Rogaining Rules* of the Australian Rogaining Association), a copy of which will be included in each competitor's race pack. Non-adherence to these rules will result in disqualification. Any event protests will be dealt with in accordance with the *Protests Procedure* detailed in all competitors' race packs.

SportIdent™: SportIdent™ electronic timing will be used for each of the rogaine events. Each team will need one e-card. A briefing concerning this system's use will be given to competitors before starting. Please enter the number of your SportIdent™ e-card on the entry form. If you don't own an e-card, you will need to either purchase one for $50 or hire one for this event only for $3 at registration.

Categories: **All** (including overseas) entries for the 24-hour event will be classified as NZ Championship competitive. Competitors in the 16-hour and 6-hour events will be classified as competitive in those (separate) events only. Standard rogaining categories will be used for all events except Juniors. Your team will be Women, Men or Mixed AND one of the following:

> *Junior** (all team members under 20 years of age on 6 March 2004)
> *Open* (at least one team member over 20 and under 40)
> *Veteran* (all team members over 40)
> *Superveteran* (all team members over 55)

(*Any team with a member under 15 must also have a member over 20)

Fees and Registration: Competitors in 24-hour Championship event $75 each. Competitors in 16-hour event $60 each. Competitors in 6-hour event $40 each. Closing date for registrations postdate **Monday 1 March 2004**. Entries after this date will be at the discretion of the organisers, and will attract a late entry fee. **No refunds will be made after 1 March 2004.** Food at the Hash-House during and after the event is included in these fees. No beverages (except water) will be made available at the Hash-House during the event and competitors should bring their own sports drinks, post-event "refreshments" etc.

Registration: Please complete attached Entry Form for each team member and post with payment to the address stipulated by **Monday 1 March 2004**.

Frequently Asked Questions:

What is a Rogaine? A rogaine is a challenge of your physical endurance and route choice skills. You visit (on foot) as many control points as you can in a given time. The points which you may visit are marked by circles, and are all on prominent features. The control points are worth different points amounts. You lose points if you return over-time. The team with the highest score at the end of the allocated time is the winner. Rogaines are usually held in scenic, bush or rural areas, although urban "metro" rogaines are also held.

What Event Options Are There? The **Green Coast 2004 NZ Rogaining Championships** will offer three separate event options:

24-hour NZ Championship Event – starts 1.00pm 6 March and finishes 1.00pm 7 March
16-hour "TestPiece" Event – starts 9.00pm* 6 March and finishes 1.00pm 7 March
6-hour "Excursion" Event – starts 7.00am 7 March and finishes 1.00pm 7 March

(*16-hour event participants can start through to 12.00am if desired, but no time allowances will be given)

It is important to note that you don't have to stay out for the whole time. You get a result no matter how many or how few controls you visit.

Safety: In bad weather the usual risk of sprained ankles may be compounded by hypothermia. If necessary, we may reduce the length of the courses by delaying the start, advancing the finish, and/or declaring some of the control points out of the event, or any other steps to minimise risks. The most important safety feature is your team, and team-mates must stay in verbal contact at all times, except to obtain help for injury. At a minimum teams must carry:

Good waterproof parka (1 per team member)
Change of warm clothing and a hat (1 set per team member)
Compass, Whistle, Torch and Survival Blanket (1 set per team member)

It is recommended that, at a minimum, at least 1.5 litres of water, 750gm of high-energy food and a basic first aid kit also be carried at all times.

What Happens on the Day? You collect your map, control list and sheet of final instructions at least 1 hour ahead of your start time (3 hours ahead for 24-hour Championship competitors). You are free to then plan your route before the start time. There is a briefing 30 minutes before start, then GO.

Control points are prominent features. You prove you have been to each one by "clicking" your SportIdent™ e-card at each control point. The winners will be those with the best combination of fitness and choice of route. You will be sent complete results and analysis of the most popular controls after the event. One of the nice things about a rogaine is that everyone (no matter which event) competes on the same map and finishes at the same time - you can compare your routes. Included in your entry is an after-event meal prepared by the local landowners, always a highlight of any rogaine.

Enquiries: The Internet: auckoc.tripod.com
www.mapsport.co.nz/rog
www.rogaine.org.nz
www.sportzhub.com

Or: Event Controller Mark Copeland at copeland@xtra.co.nz